

Payment Chronicle by Gajanan

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Companies: Square, Adyen

Article 1

Adyen's US push: one platform to run checkout, payouts and data

Adyen just used a San Francisco spotlight to remind everyone it's not merely a processor—it's selling a one stop operating system for money movement. The company announced an expansion of its capabilities in the US, doubling down on the idea that big merchants and platforms shouldn't have to stitch together gateways, acquirers, fraud tools and payout providers. What it means: fewer vendors to manage, a single data layer across online and in store sales, and the promise of better authorization rates and faster payouts because everything sits on one stack. For payment execs, this is classic Adyen—go deep with enterprise customers, use direct network connections and global consistency to squeeze out costs and latency, then layer on value adds. The knock on effect? More pressure on legacy acquirers and patchwork PSPs that rely on reselling or integrating third party tools. The risks are familiar too: take rate pressure in a competitive US market, higher expectations on service reliability, and the perennial question of merchant lock in. Watch adoption by large US retailers and platforms, attach rates for add ons, and whether rivals can match the end to end pitch without the seams showing.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-goes-live-with-tap-to-pay-on-iphone/>

Article 2

Adyen taps Plaid to push pay by bank into the mainstream

Adyen just linked up with Plaid, and the subtext is simple: make bank to bank payments as easy as card swipes. Plaid brings its pipes for secure bank account connectivity and verification; Adyen plugs that into its checkout, risk and acquiring stack. For merchants, that means you can nudge customers toward pay by bank (think ACH or other account to account rails) with fewer drop offs, fewer insufficient funds surprises, and lower acceptance costs than cards. For Adyen, it's a way to deepen control of the payment flow, diversify beyond card networks, and pitch a more defensible, end to end stack to enterprises. And Plaid gets enterprise distribution without owning the checkout. The catch? Behavior change is slow, settlement and dispute norms differ from cards, and not every use case will migrate. But expect large billers, subscriptions, wallets and marketplaces to lean in, especially where margins are tight. Net net: if this pairing nudges even a small slice of volume off cards, it pressures interchange heavy economics at the edges and accelerates the quiet rise of pay by bank as a mainstream option.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-and-plaid-partnership-what-it-means/>

Article 3

Adyen doubles down on BNPL with Klarna as holiday splurge nears

Buy now, pay later is getting a festive glow up, and Adyen wants in. With BNPL use set to jump this holiday season, the Dutch payments processor is expanding access to Klarna's installment option across its merchant network. The pitch is simple: put Klarna's pay in parts button front and centre at checkout, cut cart abandonment, and nudge shoppers into bigger baskets without merchants taking on credit risk.

What it means: Adyen is leaning into its core playbook—be the neutral, one stop checkout that routes to whatever payment method converts best. BNPL keeps winning share with younger, credit averse consumers, and adding deeper Klarna rails can lift authorization rates and order values for retailers in the crucial quarter. For Adyen, more alternative payment volume = stickier merchants and a buffer against rivals like Stripe and PayPal. For Klarna, plugging into Adyen's global acquiring footprint can trim costs and boost approvals.

There's a catch: regulators are circling BNPL, and margins on these transactions can be thinner once fees stack up. But for now, Adyen gets the upside of the BNPL boom without touching the lending risk—classic “picks and shovels” in a holiday gold rush.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/klarna-and-adyen-team-up-for-in-store-bnpl/>

Article 4

Square flips on a Bitcoin button for small businesses

Square just gave mom and pop shops a Bitcoin button. As small businesses feel the heat to keep up with tech savvy shoppers, Square is adding the option to accept bitcoin at checkout through its existing tools. The pitch is simple: let customers pay in BTC while Square handles the plumbing—price quotes, conversion and reconciliation—so merchants can focus on sales instead of wallets and private keys.

Why it matters: alternative rails are inching into the mainstream. For merchants, this could be a way to court younger, crypto holding customers, lower payment costs on some transactions, and reach cross border buyers without card rails. For Block (Square's parent), it extends a long running Bitcoin thesis across its merchant and consumer ecosystems.

But there are caveats. Volatility, refunds, tax treatment and compliance still make crypto acceptance more complex than swiping a card. Most sellers will likely opt to auto convert to local currency to avoid price swings, keeping this an experimentation channel rather than a volume driver—at least for now. The takeaway: it's less “ditch cards tomorrow” and more “add a new rail and learn,” as payment providers race to offer every checkout option customers might ask for.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-adds-bitcoin-payments-and-upgrades-ai-for-small-businesses/>

Square rolls out 'Handheld', a phone-free POS to go deeper into pro merchant lanes

Square made its name turning smartphones into card readers. Now it's flipping the script. The company has launched Handheld, a purpose-built, all in one POS that doesn't need a separate phone or tablet. Think of it as Square's bid to meet growing demand from multi site retailers and restaurants that want rugged, shared devices, consistent checkout flows, and fewer IT headaches than staff phones. The move puts Square squarely in the lane of Toast, Clover, and Android-based terminals from legacy OEMs, while giving it tighter control over hardware, software, and the payments UX. For merchants, it promises faster line-busting, tableside ordering, and reduced friction around device ownership and MDM. For Square, it's about higher ARPU via hardware-plus-software bundles, deeper ecosystem lock in, and less dependency on Apple/Google handset policies. The catch? Hardware is capital-intensive, margins are thinner, and support expectations rise. But if Handheld helps Square win larger, operationally complex accounts—and standardize endpoints across Tap to Pay, countertop, and mobile—it could shift share away from third party terminals and accelerate the trend toward integrated, software-led acquiring.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-aims-to-move-upmarket-with-handheld-pos-device/>

